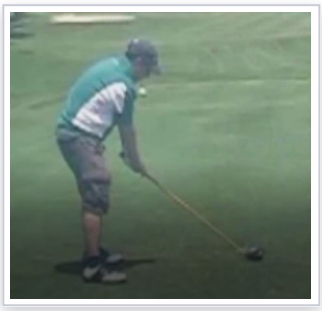
Picko

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BDT 2020 · The Belfry · Featuring Picko

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Picko left us on 19 April 2020, passing away with pancreatitis which led to multi-organ failure. He left behind his mum Glenis, sister Julie and, most tragically, his daughter Ava.



The Picko Set-Up!

It was such sad news and he went well before his time should have been up.

Although he hadn't toured since BDT 2008, up to that point he had been a regular tourist who attended every tour between BDT 2003 and BDT 2008. We had a lot of fun with Picko back in those days and he is remembered fondly by all those who toured with him.

A couple of my own favourite memories of Picko on tour came on the consecutive tours of BDT 2007 and 2008.

After BDT 2007 had finished we were flying back to London from Dubai. The Dogs had checked in relatively late on, meaning that we were all sitting solo and scattered over all parts of the BA plane. As each Dog took his seat, there was great nervousness about who they might be seated next to given there lay ahead an eight-hour flight accompanied by the Dreaded Demons.

Some of the Dogs dotted around the back of the plane were a little bemused as they noticed that the shoulders of those Dogs towards the front had started shaking uncontrollably; it soon became clear why.

A chap was heading down the plane who at a conservative estimate would have weighed in at 25 stone, with a few pounds just about to be added by the 14" pizza he was balancing in one hand!

As he passed each row of seats containing a Dog, that Dog would turn around with a mixture of massive relief and utter joy to watch the scene unfold – it was like witnessing the biggest unplanned game of spoof ever held on tour.

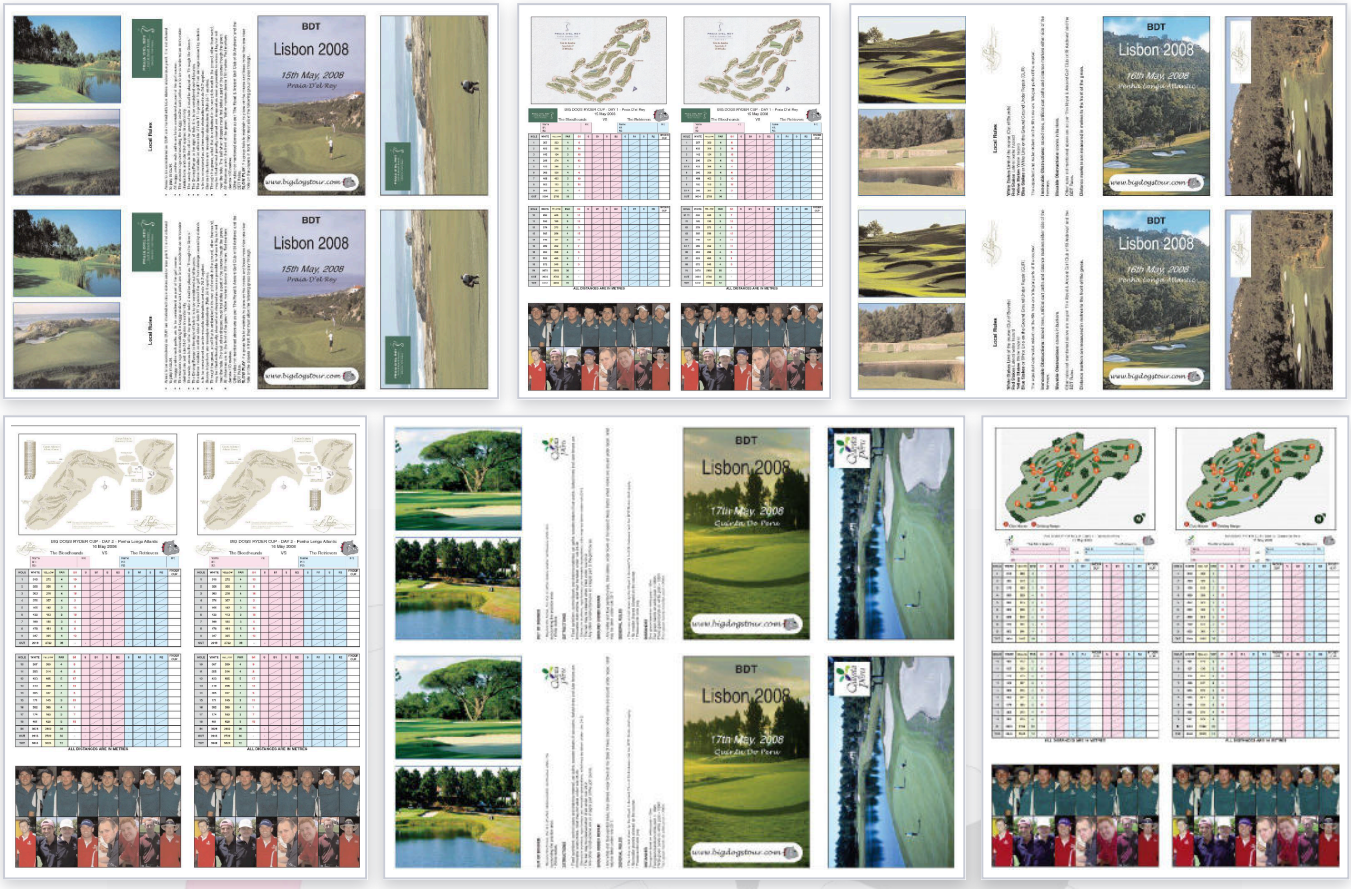
And then it happened, he arrived at his seat, right next to a delighted-looking Picko – cue much laughter and zero sympathy from the rest of the Dogs!



Pickofords!

At the 2008 OC came one of my favourite nicknames, that of "Pickofords" following a memorable story of a house move assisted by Pickfords going badly wrong with suitcases bouncing all over the M62 and clothes flying around everywhere!

In his professional life Picko ran a printing business and he and I spent some considerable time creating scorecards and other stationery for the group and some of his products from his final tour can be seen in the photos below.



Picko's Scorecards

When trawling back through the tour archives for stories of Picko I stumbled across this amusing encounter he had with Big Buzz. This came the day after Picko had seriously struggled with a game of "Famous Johns" during which he was unable to name any and suffered the consequences!



BUZZ

"It was the 'Dark Tour' of Vilamoura 2005, playing the final day at Vila Sol. I was up against Picko Dog.

I'd been struggling all tour, having had the worst round of Round I and only marginally avoiding being Shitzu on Round II. We get to the 6th, and I'm one down. It's a 525 yard par 5 with water about 300-ish yards away.

The advice of the stroke saver was:

"Ensure the tee shot is as close to the lake as possible, making it possible for high handicap players to cross the lake and low handicap players to make the green".

Deciding not to risk it, I determined to ignore this advice and took out my 3 wood for safety and did just that, or so I thought!

I proceeded to smoke it straight down the middle. As the ball approached the fairway it decided to connect with the only rock-solid piece of fairway in the Algarve and kicked forward about 50 yards and straight into the water! To say I was unimpressed was an understatement.

> Recomposed after a 300 + yard walk I decided to take a drop in front of the lake and proceeded to top it straight in the lake again...and again. The best part of 10 quid's worth of Pro V1 gone in 3 shots!
>
> I was thinking about picking up, when Picko stuffed his OB, then playing 6. Game on, I thought, 3 iron onto the green and I'm back in it!! Decent strike but a slice OB! The rest of the hole is a bit of a blur but I ended up losing the hole to Picko's net 11 (eleven)! Then the match and needless to say I was the 2005 Shitzu. Good!"

As an aside, Langrish (who was playing in the same group as Picko and Buzz) described a typical experience on the tee watching this match:

> 
> LANGRISH
>
> "8 practice swings by Buzz, 1 min over the ball, back swing, Picko's mobile goes off, stop back swing, 8 practice swings, 1 min over the ball, back swing, follow through, ball circa 2 feet to the left of original lie!"

Tour golf at its finest.

A prolific slicer of the golf ball, some will also remember Picko's ridiculously risky chipping action. He would hit a full swing flop shot for every chip!

A Retriever at heart he played 15 Ryder Cup matches and his W-L-H record was ultimately a winning one of 8-7-0.

It feels appropriate to finish with some photos of Picko in action and also a couple of short videos of him chuckling away during the making of the BDT 2009 Preview DVD.

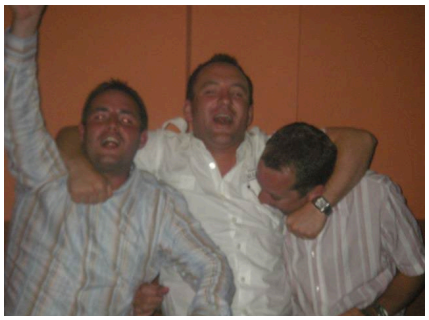
We will remember him on tour and may he Rest In Peace.



RIP Picko







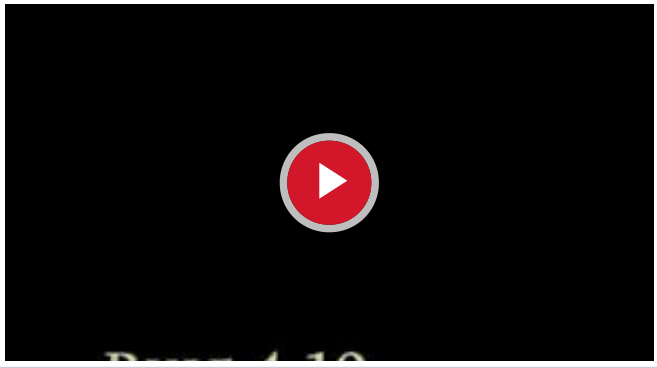








▶ **Watch:** Picko Demonstrates The Left Hand Rule!



▶ **Watch:** Picko (And Ravo) With No Practice Swing!